

Software Modernization Strategies

In

**Ignore
It!**

Leave your system alone as long as it does its job well.

K

**Keep
It Alive!**

Keep your legacy system running, but make it a conscious choice, not a habit.

De

Delegate!

Hand off what is holding you back and focus on what actually matters.

G

**Give
It Away!**

Open-source what you can no longer advance alone, and let the community share the load.

Si

Sell It!

Sell your legacy system to someone for whom it is worth more than it is to you.

Bn

Buy New!

Buy a ready-made solution when someone else has already solved your problem.

Sd

**Shut
It Down!**

End your legacy system's operation in a planned, orderly, and drama-free way.

Cs

**Consolidate
It!**

Replace your zoo of systems with fewer, more manageable units.

Sa

**Standardize
It!**

Define how your systems are built, connected, and operated, and end the chaos.

H

**Harmonize
It!**

Align your systems, models, and processes so they work together without friction.

Pn

**Partner
It!**

Work with external partners to evolve your system together.

Bi

**Bring
It Back!**

Take back control of your system when outsourcing costs more than it delivers.

Rt

**Rethink
It!**

Do not question your system, question the assumptions it was built on.

Rm

**Remodel
It!**

Align your system's structure with the domain as you understand it today.

T

**Trim
it down!**

Remove what nobody needs anymore and give your system its actual purpose back.

Ip

**Improve
It!**

Keep your system fit through continuous, unspectacular work before the debt catches up with you.

Cv

**Convert
it!**

Keep your system's proven logic and only swap out the technology it lives in.

F

Fork It!

Split off part of your system and turn it into a standalone, independent solution.

Rp

**Repurpose
It!**

Deploy your system for a new audience instead of maintaining it for a shrinking market.

Sv

**Salvage
It!**

Keep the valuable components of your legacy system and leave the rest behind.

W

Wrap it!

Leave the core untouched and only modernize how your system talks to the outside world.

Ri

**Replace
it!**

Build new when the old system is more burden than value.

Dv

**Divide
It!**

Cut your system along its natural boundaries so one change no longer puts the whole system at risk.

E

Extract!

Pull the knowledge out of your system before you take the next step.

Ps

**Preserve
it!**

Preserve your system so you can still start it when needed, without actively maintaining it.

Rf

**Replatform
it!**

Give your system a new foundation when the code is still good but what is underneath no longer is.

Rh

**Rehost
it!**

Move your system to a new environment and leave everything else as it is.

Ug

**Upgrade
Tools!**

Bring your tooling up to date so legacy work becomes more efficient.

A

**Align
Strategy!**

Align your organization's strategic direction toward a realistic approach to legacy.

Rs

**Reshape
Org!**

Reshape teams, responsibilities, and incentives so legacy work finally works well.

Us

**Upskill
People!**

Invest in the people you already have before investing in new technology.

Im

**Improve
Processes!**

Improve not the system, but the way your team works with it.

Strategy Categories:  Business (14)  Development (10)  Infrastructure (3)  Enablement (5)

